

ST. HERMAN OF ALASKA: YOUR PATRON SAINT

SESSION 00.12 HANDOUT

This Saturday, August 9, is the feast of your patron St. Herman. Light a candle that day. Greet him.

NAME _____ DATE _____

✦ MEMORY VERSE — COPY BY HAND

The Apostle Paul wrote this to the Hebrew Christians. The "cloud of witnesses" is the saints — alive, watching, praying for us as we run our race. St. Herman is one of them. He is yours. Copy the verse below twice in your best handwriting.

Therefore we also, since we are surrounded by so great a cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight, and the sin which so easily ensnares us, and let us run with endurance the race that is set before us. — Hebrews 12:1

✦ VOCABULARY — MATCH EACH WORD TO ITS MEANING

Draw a line from each word on the left to its meaning on the right.

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|---------------|---|---|
| PATRON SAINT | • | • Greek for <i>Wonderworker</i> — a title given to saints whose lives manifested extraordinary miraculous gifts. St. Herman is one. |
| WONDERWORKER | • | • Your particular friend in heaven, given (Thaumaturgos) to you at your Chrismation. Knows your name. Prays for you specifically. His feast is part of your year now. |
| GLORIFICATION | • | • The original people of Kodiak Island and the Aleutian chain in Alaska, whom St. Herman defended against Russian fur traders and called <i>abba</i> — father. |
| ALEUT PEOPLE | • | • The moment when the Orthodox Church officially recognizes someone as a saint. St. Herman was glorified in 1970. |

✦ TIMELINE — THE LIFE OF ST. HERMAN

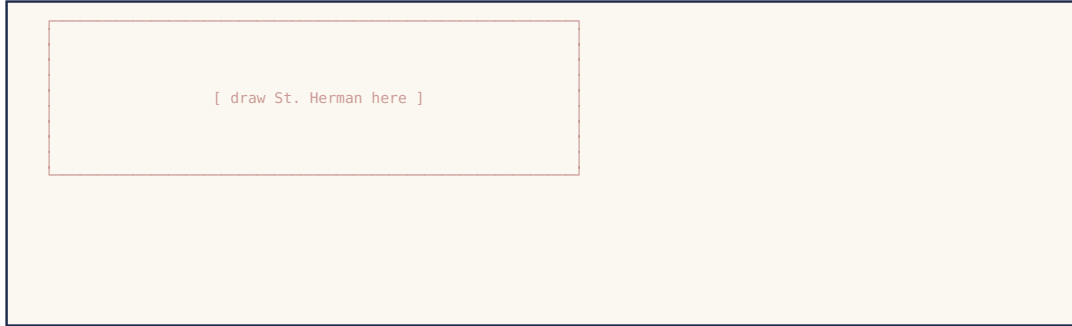
Use the word bank to fill in each blank. **Word bank:** 1756 · 1794 · 1837 · 1970

YEAR	WHAT HAPPENED
_____	St. Herman is born in a small Russian town near Moscow.
_____	He arrives in Kodiak, Alaska as a missionary monk. He will never return to Russia.
_____	He falls asleep in his hermitage on Spruce Island, age about 80. The Aleut people bury him.
_____	The Orthodox Church officially glorifies him as the first canonized saint of North America.

✦ SKETCH — YOUR PATRON SAINT

Draw an icon of St. Herman of Alaska in the box below. Look up an icon of him online or in a book if you've never seen one. He is usually shown:

- With a **black monk's robe** and a **long beard**
- Holding a **cross** in one hand
- Sometimes with **Spruce Island** behind him, or **wild animals** at his feet (bears and ermines came to him)
- Write below the icon: *Holy Father Herman, my patron, pray to God for me.*



✦ REFLECTION — WRITE 3 TO 5 SENTENCES

St. Herman left his home, his country, and his language to go to the end of the world for the Aleut people no one else would defend. The lesson said: *that is the shape of his holiness — he loved the people no one else would love.* Write 3 to 5 sentences. What is something hard you'd be willing to do for someone you love? Or — are there people in your life, at school or in your neighborhood, who no one else seems to love or defend? What might it look like to follow your patron, in a small way? *It's okay to keep this short. Even one sentence about one specific person is enough.*
